

Luc Succes

Fractional CTO / Founder

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SUMMARY

Technical leader and 3x startup CTO with 12+ years building and scaling engineering teams. Founded multiple venture-backed companies including a YC-backed fintech startup. Experienced in hiring from zero, defining architecture, and establishing engineering culture. Track record of raising \$5.5M+ in venture funding, shipping products to millions of users, and mentoring engineers from junior to senior. Currently shipping production AI agents that move real money — multi-provider agent runtimes, MCP surfaces, and the eval and safety infrastructure that makes them trustworthy.

SKILLS

AI & Agents	Agent Architecture, Tool Calling, Agent Evals, LLM Safety, Context Engineering, RAG
Product	Product Building, 0-to-1 Ideation, ICP Discovery, User Research
Go-to-Market	Sales, Marketing, Pricing, Fundraising
Strategy & Team	Tech Stack Selection, AI Build vs Buy, Technical Hiring, Team Building

EXPERIENCE

Blaze	May 2023 - Present
Co-Founder & CTO	Remote

- Built and architected an AI-powered fintech company from zero, scaling payments to 80+ currencies across 40+ countries
- Raised \$1.2M including Y Combinator (S24), owning the technical narrative for investor pitches
- Shipped an AI CFO agent with 73 tools spanning live banking, payables, receivables, payroll, and accounting data
- Architected a model-agnostic agent runtime, making providers and models swappable from an admin console without a code release
- Owned the safety model for agents that move real money, gating every write behind user confirmation and capped autonomous limits
- Built the eval infrastructure that gates each release, covering 66 behavioral scenarios and a 103-turn endurance test

Seasons	July 2019 - February 2022
Co-Founder & CTO	New York, NY

- Hired and mentored a team of 7 engineers from scratch, establishing engineering culture, leveling, and career growth frameworks
- Architected full platform from zero: React Native apps, Node.js backend, PostgreSQL database, and AWS infrastructure
- Made key build-vs-buy decisions for inventory management, payments, and logistics integrations
- Led technical due diligence process for \$4.3M raise from top VCs
- Managed vendor relationships and cloud infrastructure budget, keeping burn rate lean while scaling to thousands of active users

Artsy

Tech Lead / Senior Software Engineer

January 2017 - September 2019

New York, NY

- Led cross-functional team of 8 engineers building collector tools serving 2M+ monthly users
- Mentored junior and mid-level engineers through code reviews, architecture discussions, and regular 1:1s
- Drove adoption of shared React component library across 4 product teams, reducing duplicate code by 60%
- Owned technical planning and sprint processes for the collector experience team
- Built auction bidding platform with real-time WebSocket integration processing \$100M+ annually

Often

Co-Founder & CTO

June 2015 - December 2016

New York, NY

- Sole technical founder: defined architecture, selected tech stack, and built entire product from ground up
- Shipped iOS keyboard app to 500K+ downloads and #1 in App Store for 72 hours
- Designed backend services handling 1M+ daily API requests with real-time content delivery
- Managed outsourced designers and QA contractors while owning all technical decisions

Spotify

Software Engineer

June 2013 - June 2015

New York, NY

- Shipped features across iOS, web, and desktop clients to 100M+ users at scale
- Learned large-scale engineering practices: feature flags, A/B testing, cross-platform architecture
- Contributed to Radio feature improvements increasing listening session length by 15%

YieldMo

Founding Engineer

June 2012 - May 2013

New York, NY

- First engineer hire: architected the entire frontend framework and ad serving platform from scratch
- Grew and mentored frontend team from 1 to 5 engineers, establishing coding standards and hiring bar
- Built high-performance JavaScript SDK handling millions of daily impressions

EDUCATION

Y Combinator

S24 Batch

2024

New York University

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science

2012

TECH STACK

AGENTS

Claude CodeCodexGrokCursorMCPClaude Agent SDKVercel AI SDK

MODELS

ClaudeGPTGemini

LLM INFRA

AWS BedrockAzure AI FoundryGoogle VertexBraintrust

PRODUCT

TypeScriptReactNext.jsReact NativeTailwind

BACKEND

Node.jsNestJSGraphQLPostgresPrismaRedis

INFRA

AWSKubernetesTerraformGitHub ActionsVercel